Meredith Sheeks

Curriculum Vitae

September 2026

210B Caldwell Hall
240 E. Cameron Ave.
Chapel Hill, NC 27514

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RESEARCH

Areas of Specialization – Ethics, Epistemology, Philosophy of Religion

Areas of Competence – Feminist Philosophy, Social & Political Philosophy, Logic, Critical Thinking, and Philosophy of Technology

EDUCATION

2021-2027 (expected) Ph.D., Philosophy, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

2019-2021 M.A., Philosophy, Northern Illinois University

2015-2019 B.S., Majors: Mathematics and Biblical and Theological Studies, Minor: Philosophy, Lee University

– *Summa cum laude*

PUBLICATIONS

Forthcoming "Trusting Morality's Authority." *Oxford Studies in Metaethics*, 22

2023 "The Myth of the Good Epistemic Bubble." *Episteme*, 20(3)

2023 "A Love that Hides." *Faith and Philosophy*, 40(2)

PRESENTATIONS

'▪' = by invitation
'*' = by peer review

Nov. 2026 (scheduled) "Testimonial Injustice and Partisanship: A Puzzle"
* PPE Society 10th Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA

Aug. 2026 "The Bind of Oppressive Double Binds"
* Rocky Mountain Ethics Congress (RoME) XIX, University of Colorado Boulder

May 2026 "Artificial Intelligence and Epistemic Expertise"
▪ Annual Transatlantic Workshop in Practical Philosophy

Apr. 2026 "Perfectly Wonderful, Perfectly Moral"
* American Philosophical Association, Pacific Division Meeting (online)

Sept. 2025 "Trusting Morality's Authority"
* 22nd Annual Madison Metaethics (MadMeta) Workshop, University of Wisconsin-Madison

Nov. 2024 "The Importance of Being Rude"
* Tennessee Philosophical Association 55th Annual Meeting, Vanderbilt University

Oct. 2024 "The Importance of Being Rude"
* Virginia Philosophical Association 85th Annual Philosophy Congress, Virginia Tech

Aug. 2024 "The Importance of Being Rude"
* Rocky Mountain Ethics Congress (RoME) XVII, University of Colorado Boulder

May 2024 "The Guilt of the Moral Minimalist"
* 14th Annual KCL-UNC Workshop

Feb. 2024 "The Myth of the Good Epistemic Bubble"
- Polarization, Disagreement, and Intellectual Humility Speaker Series, Bowdoin College (online)

Jan. 2024 "The Guilt of the Moral Minimalist"
* American Philosophical Association, Eastern Division Meeting

Oct. 2023 "The Dilemma of the Many or the Few"
* Georgia Philosophical Society, Fall Meeting, Georgia College & State University

May 2023 "The Guilt of the Moral Minimalist"
- Annual Transatlantic Workshop in Practical Philosophy

Mar. 2023 "The Guilt of the Moral Minimalist"
* North Carolina Philosophical Society Meeting, Duke University

Feb. 2023 "The Case of the Missing Normative Authority"
* Duke-UNC Graduate Workshop in Philosophy

Nov. 2019 "Distinguishing Between Friends: Mary Astell's Missional Friendship"
* Illinois Philosophical Association, Annual Meeting, Illinois State University

Apr. 2019 "On Combating Moral Stagnation and Disappointment"
- Alpha Chi, Academic Showcase, Lee University

Apr. 2018 "Needing Not a Teacher"
- Alpha Chi, Academic Showcase, Lee University

Mar. 2018 "Needing Not a Teacher: On the Importance of Humility"
* 19th Annual Southern Appalachian Undergraduate Philosophy Conference, University of North Carolina at Asheville

Jul. 2017 "Proving the Proof-less Profitable"
- The Mathematical Association of America's MathFest, Chicago

Apr. 2016 "Ascertaining then Persuading"
- Mathematics and Science Symposium, Lee University

Apr. 2015 "Progress in Proving the Disproof: on the Collatz Conjecture"
- Mathematics and Science Symposium, Lee University

OTHER CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

'▪' = by open invitation
'●' = by invitation following peer review

Feb. 2027 (scheduled) Comments on Andrew Sullivan's "Wolf's Social Command Theory of Moral Obligation: A Problem and a Sketch of a Solution"
- American Philosophical Association, Central Division Meeting

Apr. 2026 Comments on Chrisoula Andreou's "Keeping Maximization in its Place"
- The 8th Annual Chapel Hill Normativity Workshop (Montreal ed.), McGill University

Apr. 2026 Comments on Florence R. Adams's "Market-Shaped Fairness"
- 2026 New Work on Discrimination Workshop, Yale University

Jan. 2026 Chair for Z Quanbeck's "The Plurality of Ethical Norms on Belief"
- 2026 Workshop in Normative Ethics (WiNE), University of Arizona

Jan. 2025 Comments on Dale Dorsey's "Doing What's Done: On Manners & Morality"
- American Philosophical Association, Eastern Division Meeting

TEACHING

2023- Instructor of Record, UNC Chapel Hill
- Practical Ethics, Spring 2027 (scheduled)
- Bioethics, Summer 2026 (online)
- Introduction to Social Ethics and Political Thought, Spring 2025
- Philosophy of Western Religion, Fall 2024
- An Introduction to Critical Thinking, Spring 2024
- Moral and Philosophical Issues of Gender in Society, Fall 2023

2022-2023 Teaching Assistant, UNC Chapel Hill

- Pandemics: Ethics, Literatures and Cultures, Spring 2023
- An Introduction to Moral Theory, Fall 2022

2019-2021 Teaching Assistant, Northern Illinois University

- Philosophy of Science, Spring 2021
- Contemporary Issues in Ethics, Fall 2020
- Feminism and Philosophy, Spring 2020
- Philosophy of Race, Fall 2019

2018-2019 Teaching Assistant, Lee University

- Introduction to Philosophy, Spring 2019
- Introduction to Philosophy, Fall 2018

2025- Guest Teaching, UNC Chapel Hill

- "Social Oppression and Individual Responsibility"
  - For Tom Dougherty's PHIL-143 Practical Ethics, Autumn 2026
- "Heckling and Free Speech"
  - For Alex Worsnip's PHIL-171 Free Speech and the Norms of Public Discourse, Feb. 2026
- "Theories of Encroachment on the Rationality of Belief"
  - For Alex Worsnip's PHIL-335 Theory of Knowledge, Nov. 2025

2017-2019 Lead tutor in mathematics, Lee University's L.E.A.P. program

2016-2017 Tutor for M^3: Mentoring Mathematicians in the Making, Lee University

2017-2019 Student Worker (grader), Mathematics, Lee University

2016-2018 Student Worker (grader), Theology, Lee University

HONORS, SCHOLARSHIPS, & AWARDS

Jun. 2026- Jul. 2026 AI + Data Ethics (AIDE) Summer Training Program ($10,000)

Apr. 2026 Pacific APA Graduate Stipend

Sep. 2025 UNC Graduate Transportation Grant (~$400)

Oct. 2024 Best Paper Prize, Virginia Philosophical Association

Jan. 2024 Eastern APA Travel Grant ($300)

2023-2024 Maynard Adams Fellow for the Public Humanities ($2,000)

2025-2026 UNC Graduate Mellon Fellow in the Humanities (~$38,000)

2023-2025 UNC Graduate Mellon Fellow in the Humanities (~$14,000/summer)

2021-	Graduate Fellow, Parr Center for Ethics, UNC Chapel Hill
2021-2022	Horace Williams Fellowship, UNC Chapel Hill (~$22,000)
2021	C. Mason and Madeline Myers Graduate Philosophy Award
2019	F.J. Lee Award
2019	Philosophy Award, Department of Theology, Lee University
2019	Theta Alpha Kappa Undergraduate Achievement Award
2018	Best paper prize, Southern Appalachian Philosophy Conference
2018	Membership Awarded to Kappa Mu Epsilon
2016	Membership Awarded to Theta Alpha Kappa
2016	Membership Awarded to Phi Eta Sigma
2015- 2019	Melody Conn Scholarship, Lee University
2015- 2019	Honors Scholarship, Lee University
2015- 2019	Presidential Scholarship, Lee University
2015	AP Scholar
2015	Tennessee Scholar

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

2026-	Moral Philosophy Pedagogy Fellow, Parr Center for Ethics
2025-2026	Tenure-track Hiring Committee Member, UNC Chapel Hill Philosophy Dept.
2025-2026	Intercollegiate Ethics Bowl Team, Graduate Mentor, Parr Center for Ethics
2025-	Access & Opportunity Committee, UNC Chapel Hill
2024-2025	Diversity Committee, UNC Chapel Hill
2023-	Referee for *Episteme*, *The Philosophical Quarterly*, *Religious Studies*
2022-	Philosophy Graduate Committee Member/Representative, UNC Chapel Hill
2022, 2023, 2024, 2025	Judge, National High School Ethics Bowl, Parr Center for Ethics
2022, '23, '24, '25, '26	Judge, North Carolina High School Ethics Bowl, Parr Center for Ethics
2022, 2023	Case Writer, APPE Intercollegiate Ethics Bowl
2021, '22, '23, '25	Case Writer, National High School Ethics Bowl
2022	Prospective Graduate Student Committee Member, UNC Chapel Hill
2021-2022	Participant, Philosophy as Mail, Parr Center for Ethics
2021- 2022	Philosophy Graduate Council Member/Representative, UNC Chapel Hill
2020-2021	Philosophy Graduate Student Advisory Council Member, NIU

2019-2021 Member of Philosophy as Literature, NIU

- Philosophy as Literature partners with the Kane County Juvenile Justice Center (JJC) in St. Charles, Illinois to provide JJC youth with weekly opportunities for philosophical discussion.

2018 Chaplain, Omega Alpha Phi, Lee University

2018-2019 President, Philosophy Club, Lee University

2017-2018 Vice President, Philosophy Club, Lee University

2016-2017 Route Leader, Crossover, Lee University

- Crossover is an ethics in action group that partners with local grocery stores to bring free fresh produce into impoverished East Tennessee neighborhoods on a weekly basis.

MEMBERSHIPS & AFFLIATIONS

2021- Affiliated Graduate Student, UNC's PPE Program

2022- Graduate Student Member, APA, Eastern Division

2021-2022 Graduate Student Member, APA, Central Division

PUBLIC PHILOSOPHY TALKS & PANEL DISCUSSIONS

'▪' = by invitation

Apr. 2027 (scheduled) "The Puzzles of Moral Deference"
- ▪ Carolina Meadows Retirement Community

Aug. 2026 Panel discussion: Time management and interacting with students
- ▪ UNC Philosophy Teaching Workshop

Apr. 2026 Panel discussion: Preparing course syllabi
- ▪ UNC Philosophy Teaching Workshop

Apr. 2025 "Pass the rudeness, please"
- ▪ Carolina Meadows Retirement Community

Apr. 2025 Panel discussion: Administration and classroom management
- ▪ UNC Philosophy Teaching Workshop

Aug. 2024 Panel discussion: Grading assignments and teaching collaboratively
- ▪ UNC Philosophy Teaching Workshop

Apr. 2024 Panel discussion: Christina LaFont, "Building Democracies in Times of Populism and Polarization"
- ▪ 7th Annual Maynard Adams Symposium for the Humanities, Hosted by Carolina Public Humanities

Mar. 2024 Panel discussion: Diversity, Inclusion, and Accessibility in the Classroom
- ▪ UNC Philosophy Teaching Workshop

Jan. 2023 "Saints, Heroes, and the Ethics of Going the Second Mile"
- ▪ Carolina Meadows Retirement Community

GRADUATE COURSE WORK

At Northeastern University

Summer 2026 AI + Data Ethics (AIDE) Summer Training Program

At UNC Chapel Hill

Spring 2024 Context-sensitivity (Alex Worsnip)
Spring 2024 Morality and Partiality (Sarah Stroud and Susan Wolf)
Spring 2024 Comprehensive Qualifying Exam in Epistemology

Fall 2023 Introduction to Formal Epistemology (Matthew Kotzen and Jim Pryor)
Fall 2023 Kant's Practical Philosophy (Markus Kohl)

Spring 2023 Aristotle (C.D.C. Reeve)
Spring 2023 Kant and Epistemic Agency (Markus Kohl and Ram Neta)
Spring 2023 Contemporary Topics in Contemporary Normative Ethics (Daniel Muñoz)
Spring 2023 Master's Research and Thesis (Thesis Advisor: Sarah Stroud)

Fall 2022 Advanced Studies in Philosophy, Politics and Economics (Luc Bovens)
Fall 2022 Philosophy of Law (Matthew Kotzen)
Fall 2022 Master's Research and Thesis (Thesis Advisor: Sarah Stroud)

Spring 2022 The Content and Epistemology of the First-Person (Ram Neta)
Spring 2022 Contemporary Moral Philosophy: Metaethics (Alex Worsnip)
Spring 2022 Symbolic Logic (Jim Pryor)
Spring 2022 Moral Responsibility (Susan Wolf)

Fall 2021 Political Epistemology and Democratic Theory (Alex Worsnip)
Fall 2021 Rationalism: Leibniz (Alan Nelson)
Fall 2021 Protoseminar (Thomas Hofweber and Sarah Stroud)
Fall 2021 Bioethics Methods (Rebecca Walker)

At Northern Illinois University

Spring 2021 Procreation & Parenthood (Jason Hanna)
Spring 2021 Blameworthiness (Alicia Finch)
Spring 2021 Consequentialism (Steve Daskal)

Fall 2020 Personal Ontology (Carl Gillett)
Fall 2020 God, Freedom, and the Self (Alicia Finch)
Fall 2020 Self-Defense and War (Jason Hanna)

Spring 2020 Free Will (Alicia Finch)
Spring 2020 Existentialism & Pragmatism (Steve Daskal)
Spring 2020 Truth (David Buller)

Fall 2019 Philosophy of Language (Lenny Clapp)
Fall 2019 Intermediate Logic (David Buller)
Fall 2019 Contemporary Problems in Social & Political Philosophy (Jason Hanna)

PEDAGOGICAL TRAINING

Mar. 2026	Online Course Development Training, UNC Chapel Hill
Mar. 2023	Teaching Workshop Spring Bootcamp, UNC Chapel Hill
Oct. 2022	Teaching Workshop, In-Class Discussion, UNC Chapel Hill
Aug. 2022	Teaching Workshop Fall Bootcamp, UNC Chapel Hill
Apr. 2022	Teaching Workshop, Syllabus Design, UNC Chapel Hill
Mar. 2022	Teaching Workshop, Promoting Diversity in the Classroom, UNC Chapel Hill
Oct. 2021	Teaching Workshop, Leading Discussions, UNC Chapel Hill
Sep. 2021	Teaching Workshop, Lecturing, UNC Chapel Hill
Aug. 2020	Teaching Assistant Institute, NIU
Aug. 2019	Teaching Assistant Institute, NIU

EXTRACURRICULAR READING GROUPS

'+' = as group leader/teacher
'*' = as active participant

Summer/Fall 2026	J.J. Thomson, *The Realm of Rights**
Fall 2025	Catharine A. MacKinnon's *Toward a Feminist Theory of the State*+ – Sponsored by UNC's PPE program for undergraduates
Summer 2025	Rae Langton, *Sexual Solipsism**
Summer 2025	T.M. Scanlon, *What We Owe to Each Other**
Spring 2025	Samuel Scheffler, *One Life to Lead**
Spring 2025	Simone de Beauvoir's *The Second Sex*+ – Sponsored by UNC's PPE program for undergraduates
Spring 2025	Mark C. Murphy's *God's Own Ethics**
Summer 2024	Scott A. Davison, *Petitionary Prayer**
Fall 2023	J.S. Mill's *The Subjection of Women*+ – Sponsored by UNC's PPE program for undergraduates
Fall 2022-Spring 2023	Barbara Herman's *The Moral Habitat**

REFERENCES

Tom Dougherty
Professor of Philosophy
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
emailtom@unc.edu

Sarah Stroud
Professor of Philosophy
Director, Parr Center for Ethics
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
sarah.stroud@unc.edu

Alex Worsnip
Professor of Philosophy
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Mariska Leunissen (teaching reference)
Professor of Philosophy
Associate Chair
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Dissertation Abstract

Meredith Sheeks

Are morality's demands *decisive* for us? For instance, when morality requires that we keep a promise, does it follow that we are *all things considered* required to keep that promise? Many philosophers say that it doesn't follow. According to them, there are times when the demands of *morality* and the demands of *practical reason* (i.e., the *all things considered* perspective) can come apart. In response to recent lines of skepticism about morality's authority over our lives, my dissertation, ***Morality without Moralizing***, argues that we are *all things considered* required to do whatever it is that we are *morally* required to do. Call this thesis 'the supremacy of morality'.

In Chapter One (**"Trusting Morality's Authority,"** forthcoming in *Oxford Studies in Metaethics*), I defend the supremacy of morality against the infamous argument from impartialism. The argument from impartialism goes roughly as follows: if impartialism about morality is true, then conflicts between the demands of morality and the demands of the people or things that give our lives meaning are inevitable. In the face of such conflicts, we are not *all things considered* required to do what *morality* would require us to do. Since impartialism is true, the supremacy of morality is false. In response to the argument from impartialism, I argue that even if impartialism is true, conflicts between the demands of morality and the demands of the people or things that give our lives meaning are *not* inevitable. For apparent conflicts between the demands of morality and the demands of the people or things that give our lives meaning are better understood as cases of indeterminacy in ethics than as cases of genuine conflict. When, for example, Agamemnon appears to face an impossible choice between the demands of impartial morality and the demands of his love for his daughter, what Agamemnon faces is a case in which morality has no determinate answer about what he must do.

In Chapter Two (**"Saints by Discretion"**), I defend the supremacy of morality against a separate argument, the argument from supererogation. A *supererogatory* action is a morally optional, morally better act. But if an action is morally better than relevant alternatives, then why wouldn't morality require it? Why would morality require less than what is morally best of us? The argument from supererogation denies that morality ever requires less of us than what's morally best and then attempts to explain why, contrary to appearances, there are no genuinely supererogatory actions. Its explanation implies that the supremacy of morality is false. In response, I show that the argument from supererogation cannot accommodate those cases in which agents appear to use a particular kind of moral discretion to go above and beyond the call of a moral requirement. The upshot is a vindication of both the supremacy of morality and of supererogatory actions.

In the third and final chapter of my dissertation, **"Perfectly Wonderful, Morally Decent,"** I develop a novel, positive case in defense of the supremacy of morality. Perhaps surprisingly, I rely on a key premise in a leading argument against the supremacy of morality, namely the premise that what we are required to do is inextricably bound up with the kinds of human beings we ought *not* to be. But I rely on this premise to *defend* the supremacy of morality. Following my opponents, I assume that we ought not to be vicious or defective human beings. We ought to be decent human beings. I then show that we cannot be decent human beings without being morally decent human beings. Along the way, I explain how my case in defense of the supremacy of morality overcomes weaknesses in extant arguments for the supremacy of morality.

Ultimately, morality's demands are decisive for us, i.e., they cannot be overridden by the demands of other practical domains. But the authority of morality is itself limited in various ways. Morality's demands are less than fully determinate, partially up to our discretion, and tempered by the aretaic realm.